Switching between versions is a matter of controlling symlinks (note that the paths will vary depending on if macOS is running on Intel - `/usr/local` - or Apple Silicon - `/opt/`):

```
$ ls -la /usr/local/bin |grep php
lrwxr-xr-x    1 root  root        28 25 Sep 20:40 php -> ../Cellar/
php/8.2.10/bin/php
```

```
$ ls -l /usr/local/lib/php/
total 0
lrwxr-xr-x  1 pault  admin   40 25 Sep 20:47 20220829 -> ../../Cellar/
php/8.2.10/lib/php/20220829
lrwxr-xr-x  1 pault  admin   37 25 Sep 20:47 build -> ../../Cellar/
php/8.2.10/lib/php/build
```

Homebrew installs packages and their dependencies into `/usr/local/Cellar/` and as we can see the conventional paths for PHP binaries and libraries are symlinked to the cellar where our various PHP version packages were installed. That's quite a few symlinks to control, fortunately it's also automated for you with `brew link` and `brew unlink`:

```
$ brew unlink php
Unlinking /usr/local/Cellar/php/8.2.10... 24 symlinks removed.
```

```
$ brew link php@7.4
Linking /usr/local/Cellar/php@7.4/7.4.33_4... 25 symlinks created.
```

```
$ php -v
PHP 7.4.33 (cli) (built: Sep  1 2023 04:09:59) ( NTS )
```

Simply `brew unlink ...` the existing linked package (you can always check the current mapping by seeing where the `/usr/local/bin/php` symlink is pointing to), then `brew link ...` the desired package.

Windows

The easiest way to install PHP onto a modern Windows system is to download the pre-built binaries from https://windows.php.net/download/. This page will offer a variety of versions, and both thread-safe and non-thread-safe variants (thread safety is